

The Austin Animal Center Proposal

Focusing on cat adoptions, this presentation will be used to support our proposal to The City of Austin

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The Austin Animal Center

- The shelter is run by the City of Austin, one of the largest no-kill states
 - largest municipal no-kill shelters
- Try to provide at least a 95% live outcome
- Partners with Austin Pets Alive! to maintain the no-kill standard
 - Taking in animals at risk of euthanasia



Our Data

- Our dataset was collected from the shelter themselves
 - Available on their website as well as Kaggle
- Only cat adoptions
- Consists of entries ranging from the end of 2013 to the beginning of 2018
 - We will focus on 2014 to 2017
- Includes variables like name, age, breed, several dates and outcome type
 - Outcome type being adoption, transfer, euthanasia, etc.

Our Proposal

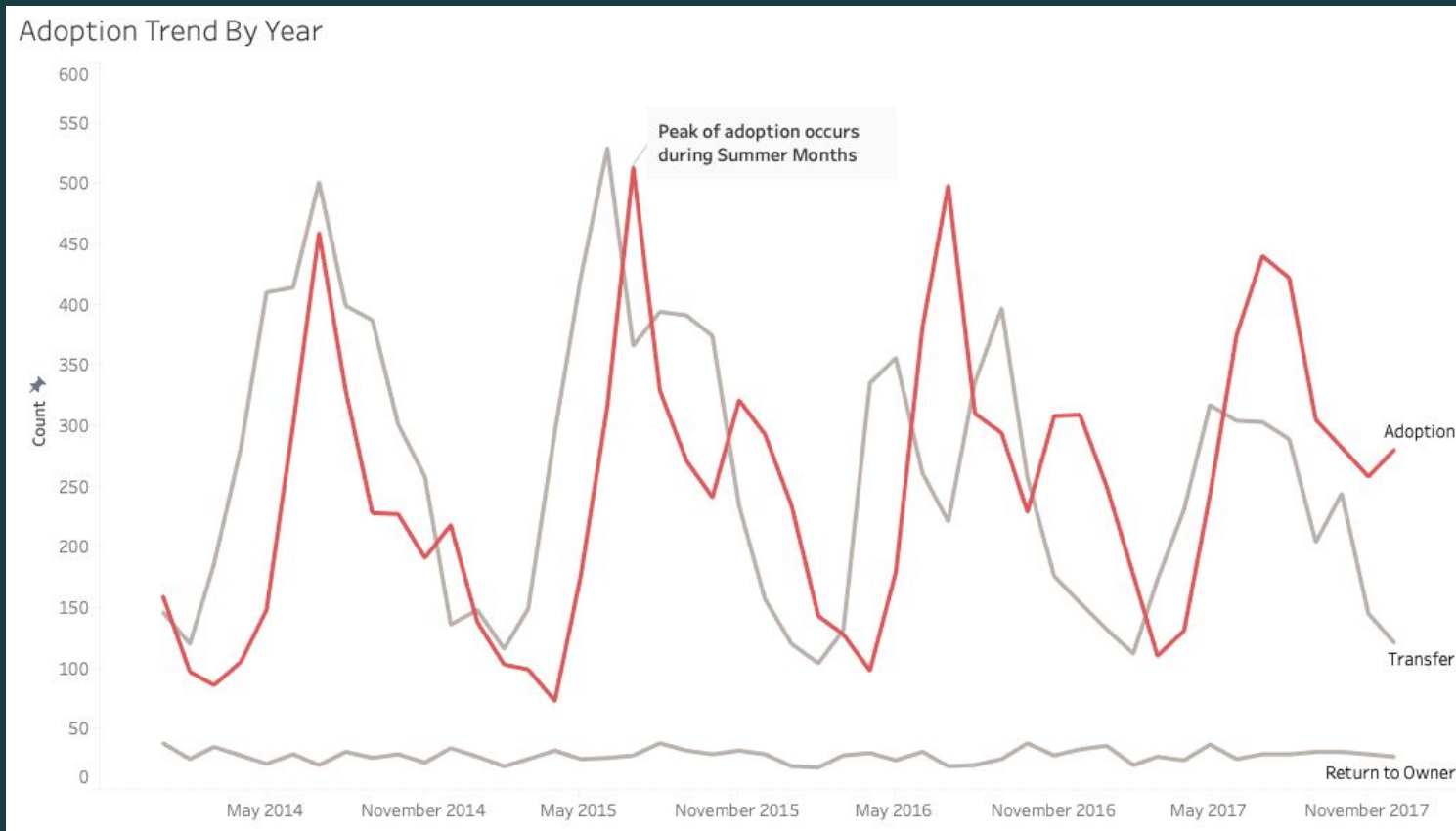
We propose raising the shelter budget for the summer season. This would support the shelter in purchasing food, covering veterinary services, hiring more staff all while still paying utility expenses to keep a consistent quality of life standard for our animals.



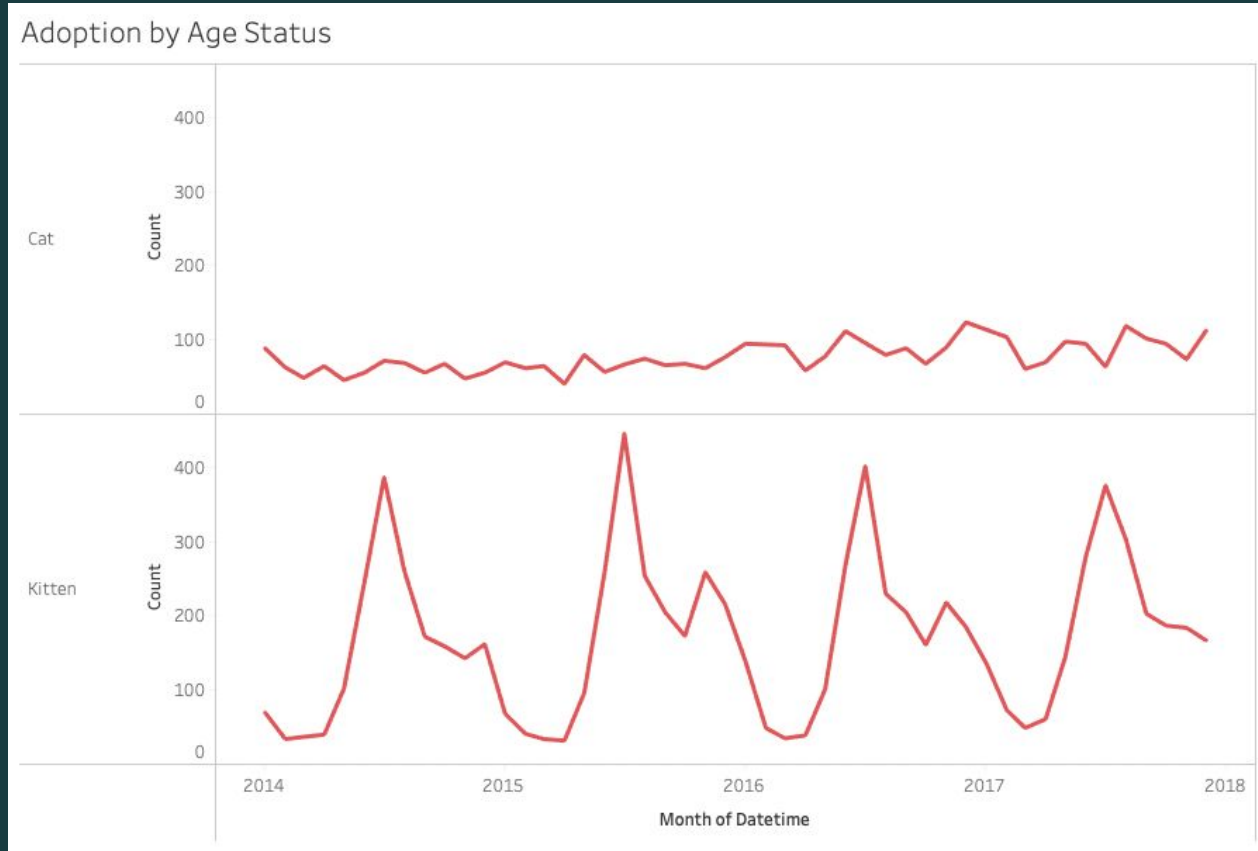
Adoption Rate and its Influences

Diving into different factors that have an effect on adoption

Overall Adoption Trend Compared to Other Outcomes



Adoption trend for Cats and Kittens

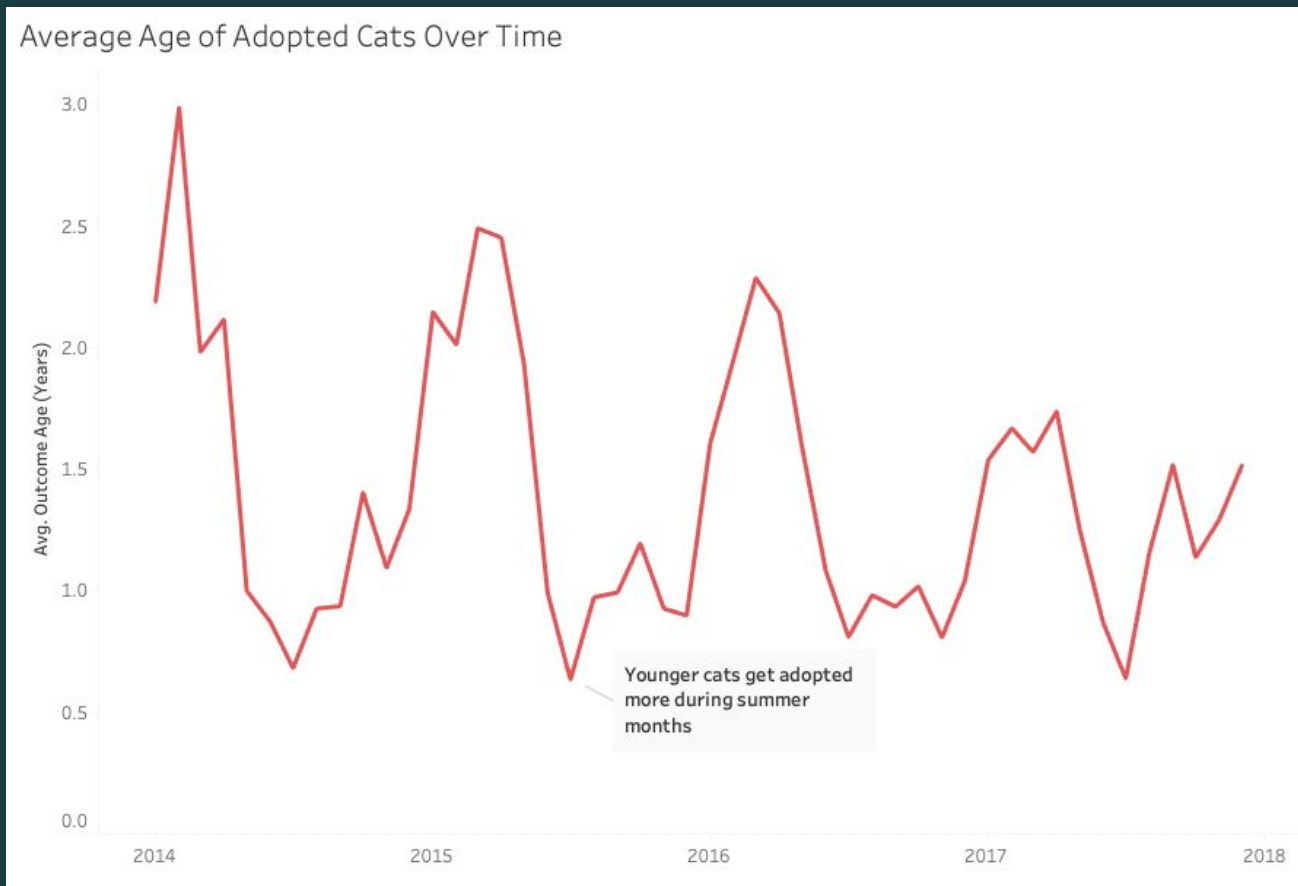


Clear Preference for Kittens

- Kittens get adopted in higher numbers than adult cats
- Adult cats get adopted consistently regardless of season
- Intake also plays a role
 - As the amount of intake increases every year, so does the amount of adoptions

		2014	2015	2016	2017
Adoption	Cat	737	790	1,078	1,109
	Kitten	1,811	2,083	2,033	2,164

Is there a consistent age that gets adopted?



Maintaining Our No-kill Status

Highlighting on what we can do to promote adoption

Does Age Have Any Effect on Outcome?

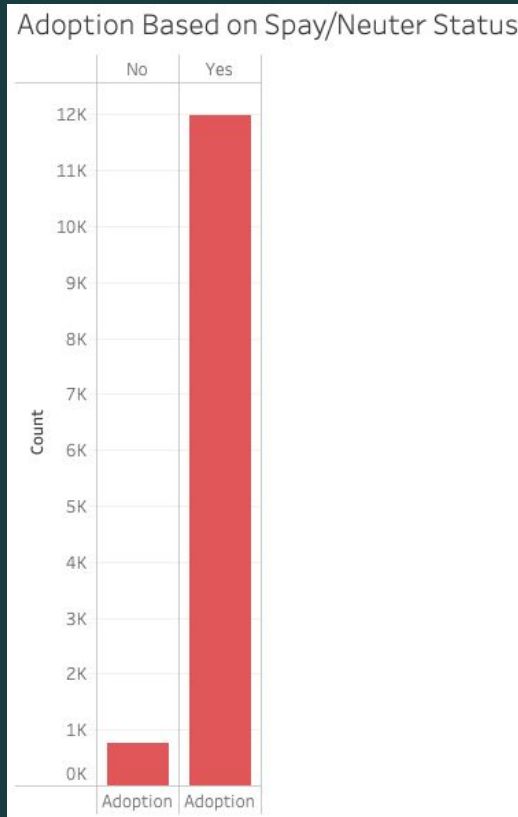
- Older cats face the risk of euthanasia
 - Due to health concerns or other reasons

Outcome Type by Average Age for Top 10 Cat Breeds

Breed	Outcome Type			
	Adoption	Euthanasia	Return to Owner	Transfer
american shorthair	1.499	4.215	3.862	1.379
domestic longhair	2.356	4.840	6.188	2.431
domestic mediumhair	1.034	3.670	4.046	1.179
domestic shorthair	1.044	2.979	3.784	0.994
himalayan	6.354	4.771	6.714	2.681
maine coon	4.449	9.500	5.973	3.852
manx	1.320	0.082	5.667	1.708
russian blue	2.120	5.000	4.511	2.295
siamese	1.743	3.161	5.315	1.404
snowshoe	1.962	0.085	5.402	1.171

Does Fixing a Cat Change Anything?

- Fixing a cat highly increases adoption compared to non-fixed cats
 - Gives us an inkling as to how much we should allocate towards spaying and neutering fees



Key Takeaways

Conclusions on what the shelter will need from the city and how it will help them

Outcomes

- With kitten season occurring during summer months, adoption is at its highest
- Kittens seem to lead adoption rates every summer but adult cats consistently get adopted every month
 - Average age of cats get younger as summer approaches
- Adoption rate highly dependent on season and somewhat on intake
 - More cats admitted = more getting adopted

Recommendations

- Increase shelter budget for summer
 - Will provide aid and promote more adoptions
 - Will help provide food and any veterinary services
- Utilize this information to divert certain resources to each aspect of the shelter

Conclusions

- Determined what factors may influence adoption and want to hone in on those factors to promote more adoptions in the future
- With the help of financial assistance of the City, we can more effectively give the cats the care that upholds the no-kill standard and reduce euthanasians

Sources

- <https://www.austintexas.gov/department/about-austin-animal-services>
- <https://www.maddiesfund.org/fellowship-apa-aac.htm#:~:text=The%20Maddie's%20AE%20Executive%20Leader,animals%20left%20in%20their%20care.>
- <https://www.austinpetsalive.org/about/our-story>
- <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/aaronschlegel/austin-animal-center-shelter-out-comes-and>

Thank you!

Any Questions?

